

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



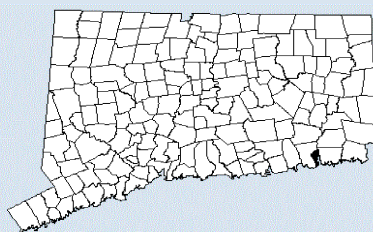
Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Dr. Nicholas Spera Sr., Superintendent • 860-447-1003 • <http://www.isaacschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	6-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	281
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,740
Total Expenditures ¹	\$4,670,482

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	6

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	155	55.2	48.4
Male	*	*	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	51	18.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	171	60.9	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	18	6.4	4.5
White	36	12.8	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	59	21.0	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	199	70.8	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	44	15.7	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	35	24.3	8	5.1
Male	31	25.4	24	18.9
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	7	14.3	8	15.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	42	25.6	18	10.5
White	9	27.3	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	12	21.4	9	15.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	54	27.4	28	13.2
Students with Disabilities	22	43.1	11	19.3
District	66	24.6	32	11.1
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 123

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	20.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	4.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	4.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	1.5
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.0
School Level	4.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	2.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	15.3

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	1	3.1	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	9.4	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	3.1	0.2
White	27	84.4	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.1	13.2

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		68.6

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.4
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.0
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.3
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.4
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$2,550,672	\$9,142	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$372,143	\$1,334	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$454,408	\$1,629	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$13,190	\$47	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$313,090	\$1,122	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$584,764	\$2,096	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$377,019	\$1,351	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$5,196	\$19	\$1,464
Food services	.	.	\$5
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$186
Total	\$4,670,482	\$16,740	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$455,111	52.7	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$36,662	4.2	10.6
Other Salaries	\$155,284	18.0	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$106,980	12.4	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$43,090	5.0	5.9
Special Education Tuition	.	.	21.8
Supplies	\$3,296	0.4	0.7
Property Services	\$62,901	7.3	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.1
Equipment	\$90	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$863,414	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		18.5	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	18.5
State	65.7
Federal	15.4
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	47	60.2	47	48.0	18	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	162	57.7	159	52.5	56	53.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	18	*	18	*	*	*
White	33	67.6	32	61.5	8	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	87	53.9	86	48.7	28	48.0
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	178	62.1	175	54.3	57	57.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	195	57.3	191	49.8	63	51.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	70	65.2	70	59.7	22	64.3
Students with Disabilities	50	40.0	47	33.9	17	*
Students without Disabilities	215	63.9	214	56.5	68	58.1
High Needs	218	56.8	214	49.5	68	51.8
Non-High Needs	47	71.1	47	66.0	17	*
District	265	59.4	261	52.5	85	54.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	98.0	95.0	N/A	178	96.6
Curl Up	N/A	87.6	86.3	N/A	177	87.0
Push Up	N/A	69.4	72.2	N/A	177	70.6
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	67.0	60.0	N/A	177	63.8
All Tests - District	N/A	50.5	50.6	N/A	176	50.6
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	59.4	75	39.6	50	79.2	63.9
	High Needs Students	56.8	75	37.9	50	75.8	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	52.5	75	35.0	50	69.9	59.7
	High Needs Students	49.5	75	33.0	50	66.0	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	54.5	75	36.3	50	72.7	61.6
	High Needs Students	51.8	75	34.6	50	69.1	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	59.5%	100%	59.5	100	59.5	57.2%
	High Needs Students	59.7%	100%	59.7	100	59.7	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	69.7%	100%	69.7	100	69.7	61.8%
	High Needs Students	69.1%	100%	69.1	100	69.1	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	76.5%	100%	38.3	50	76.5	55.3%
	Oral	80.5%	100%	40.2	50	80.5	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	24.6%	<=5%	10.7	50	21.5	20.0%
	High Needs Students	26.1%	<=5%	7.9	50	15.7	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.3%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		.	75%	.	.	.	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		95.2% 50.6%	75%	33.7	50	67.4	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	54.5%
Accountability Index				655.2	1000	65.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	71.1	56.8	14.3	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	66.0	49.5	16.5	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	.	51.8	.	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.5
	High Needs Students	98.6
Math	All Students	97.0
	High Needs Students	96.8
Science	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	97.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.6

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Family Engagement:

ISAAC has consistently prioritized engaging families in student learning, and we have implemented various initiatives to foster a strong sense of community. As part of our new Strategic Action Plan, we have placed a significant focus on reaching out to our community. Moreover, we are thrilled to be in the second year of a five-year 21st Century Community Learning Centers Grant, which includes a component specifically dedicated to family outreach. Over the past two years, ISAAC has successfully engaged families through a range of events and activities, such as Community and Family Dance and Dines, Family Meals, and Wellness Workshops. These endeavors have proven to be wonderful opportunities for fostering connections and collaboration between ISAAC families and the broader community. We are excited about our future plans and events that will continue to bring our ISAAC families and the community together.

Communication:

ISAAC, strongly believes that effective communication is fundamental to enhancing and promoting a positive culture and climate among the school, families, and the wider community. ISAAC actively encourages families to join the ISAAC Parent-Teacher Organization (PTO) to foster greater involvement and collaboration. To ensure consistent and timely communication, the school Principal utilizes various social media platforms including Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, reaching out to families with important updates, events, and highlights. Our weekly newsletter, Dragon Tales, keeps families informed about the latest happenings and upcoming events. In addition, ISAAC utilizes School Messenger, letters, and text messages to provide timely and accessible access to school information to ISAAC families. To ensure that we are meeting the needs of our community, ISAAC conducts surveys twice a year, seeking feedback regarding school communication, academics, and safety. Through these comprehensive communication channels and strategies, ISAAC aims to maintain a strong partnership with its families and continuously improve the overall school experience for its students.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication has undergone many efforts to foster a more inclusive and equitable learning environment and reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. One of the strategies we have used is to provide our faculty, staff, and administrators with diversity and inclusion training with a focus on cultural competency and implicit bias training to understand and try to address the unique challenges and needs of students from diverse backgrounds. We have also partnered with the Anti-defamation League to become a "No Place for Hate" school that helps build a learning community of inclusivity, respect, and equity.

Additionally, we have made several attempts at community outreach to actively engage with our families and develop partnerships with community organizations through our after-school programming and recently acquired grants. This helps our students and families feel connected to the school, as evidenced by our recent increased parental engagement survey results. We also actively engage parents and community members through regular communication from our weekly newsletters (English and Spanish versions), social media updates, and regular calls from school. Families are also encouraged to become involved in the decision-making processes by inclusion in organizations like the Parent Teacher Organization. Lastly, families are encouraged to come to the school to participate in school events like our theater, music, and band performances.

Our administrative team regularly meets to conduct equity audits of our disciplinary, attendance, and academic data to ensure equity. We regularly collect and analyze data related to student demographics, academic achievement, and disciplinary actions to identify disparities and assess the effectiveness of implemented strategies. This data-driven approach helps us to identify areas that require further attention and measure progress over time. We have also increased our minority staff and hired additional bilingual, academic, and behavioral interventionists.

We realize that it is important to address racial, ethnic, and economic isolation but know it is an ongoing process that requires sustained commitment and collaboration from all stakeholders.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Interdistrict School for Arts and Comm District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Ensuring equitable allocation of resources at the Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication is crucial to provide all students with equal opportunities and support their educational and artistic growth. Here are some key considerations and strategies that can be implemented to achieve equitable resource allocation:

- Needs Assessment: Conduct a comprehensive needs assessment to identify the specific requirements of different student populations. This assessment will help in understanding the unique needs of the students and inform resource allocation decisions.

- Transparent Budgeting: Maintain transparency in the budgeting process by clearly communicating how resources are allocated and involving stakeholders, including students, parents, teachers, and administrators. This ensures that all parties are aware of the available resources and how they will be distributed.

- Adequate Funding: Advocate for adequate funding to support our students. This can involve writing grants to secure additional funding for the school. Sufficient resources enable the school to provide quality programs, materials, and facilities for all students.